

THE SOCIAL UNIVERSE (TSU)

Extended Ensemble — Supporting & Recurring Characters

Status: Open / expanding. This doc houses everyone orbiting the core seven — the people who make TSU's world feel like a real, populated industry rather than seven friends alone on an island. Pulls from the full, diverse entertainment and tech world TSU is set in, per the "real world, just with a Black core cast" framing established in the Core Cast doc.

Companion docs: TSU_Platform_Roster.md · TSU_Core_Cast.md · TSU_Continuity_Bible.md

THE RIVALS

Other founders. Not villains — competitors, which is scarier, because they're right often enough to be dangerous.

CASSIUS WREN — The founder energy of a man who's never once doubted himself, which is either his superpower or the thing that eventually ends him. Late 20s, Ivy League dropout (the kind of dropout who makes sure you know it was a choice), impossibly online before "being online" was a personality trait. Cassius is building in the same lane as one of the core seven and he is *faster* — not smarter, not more talented, just relentlessly, almost inhumanly faster, first to every feature, first to every headline. He's not cartoonishly evil; he genuinely believes speed is a moral good, that hesitation is just fear wearing a nicer outfit. That conviction is what makes him dangerous to write against a character like Amond, whose whole arc is about being underestimated for being too careful. Returns in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`, seven years further into the same unrevised conviction, at the scale of THE EVERYTHING — his conviction never bends, which is exactly why it finally breaks.

PRIYA RAMASUBRAMANIAN — The investor everyone underestimates until the term sheet lands on the table and it's somehow better than the one from the firm with the famous name on the door. Early 30s, quietly the sharpest read-of-a-room in any scene she's in, built her fund from nothing after being passed over for partner at a legacy firm that's now begging to co-invest with her. She's not a rival to the founders so much as a rival *for* them — every platform in Phase 1 and 2 eventually needs her money, and she's the one person in the ensemble with the leverage to be in five different founders' origin stories without ever founding anything herself. Recurring across Phases by design (see Continuity Bible §1 — she's a 30%-bucket character).

CELESTE MARLOWE — A beauty-and-image industry veteran, genuinely brilliant, who has spent two decades monetizing the same comparison culture that wounded Arianna Cummings, and believes without irony that she's serving a real human desire rather than exploiting one. Backed by Delphine Okonkwo-Ash, she builds a filter-and-rating app engineered to be maximally addictive off the same insecurity `scripts/THE_FRAME.md` is built to undercut. Not defeated in a confrontation — outlasted, the way an ideology outlives a single fight.

MALCOLM PIERCE — A documentary photographer, unassuming, with a genuine eye and no following of his own — the first person to see Arianna Cummings clearly rather than politely. Co-creates THE

FRAME with her without becoming a co-founder-dispute figure (that structure already ran twice in the franchise); fills the "the one who sees you before anyone else does" position instead. Arianna's Core Cast bio never locked a romantic partner — Malcolm originates that arc in `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`.

VERNON PRICE — A content-farm operator from the internet's earliest, ugliest days — the guy who flooded pre-THE PROJECTOR video-sharing forums with cheap, algorithm-gaming garbage before "creator-first" curation pushed his approach to the margins. Not defeated, per the Villains Bench pattern this franchise keeps returning to — outlasted, the way an ideology outlives a single fight. He spent the years since refining an AI-content-generation operation in less regulated corners of the internet, and resurfaces in `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md` with THE LULLABY: infinite, algorithmically-optimized "children's content," marketed as soothing and safe, engineered underneath for maximum addictive engagement regardless of what it costs the kids watching it. Backed a second time by Maxwell Sterling Asante's money.

ELDRIDGE KANE — A self-taught security engineer, technically brilliant, driven by a real and specific inherited grievance rather than generic villainy: his father, Solomon Kane, claims a 1958 handshake deal with Victor Donohue got quietly written out of the record on the way to "The Donohue Breakthrough" becoming legend (`TSU_Historical_Context.md` §5). Not a hacker-for-hire and not interested in money — he wants the industry's premise about who gets to be trusted turned back on itself, publicly, which is exactly what he does to THE ROSTER in `scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md`. The film deliberately never fully absolves Victor Donohue, and neither does Eldridge's bible entry.

CARTER WESTBROOK — TOP8's founder, watching his company die in public during the Feed War (`TSU_Continuity_Bible.md` §3) and making one desperate, understandable, wrong decision on the way down: bankrolling Eldridge Kane's attack on THE ROSTER through Maxwell Sterling Asante's money. Not written as a villain — a direct, deliberate contrast with Marc-Anthony, two founders under identical pressure, one with people left to lean on and one without.

JAMAL KESTER — Tyrese Avery's longtime, never-billed co-writer and producer, the actual author of much of Tyrese's biggest catalog. Not a villain by any measure of `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md` — his public exposure of Tyrese's credit theft is overdue, not sabotage, and the film is careful never to frame him as an antagonist. Estranged for years from his sister, Dr. Simone Kester, over a smaller, quieter version of the same "uncredited" wound.

DR. SIMONE KESTER — Jamal Kester's older sister, a sharp, unimpressed contract engineer running a small shop in Atlanta, and the first person in years to have no interest whatsoever in who Tyrese Avery is or was. Tyrese's Core Cast bio never locked a romantic partner the way the other six core-seven members did — Simone originates that arc in `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR.md` without contradicting anything previously on the books.

DESMOND OKAFOR-LINDQVIST — The rival who was right about everything and still lost. Built a platform in Phase 2 that does, technically, everything THE GALLERY or THE HIVE eventually does — just two years too early, with a UI nobody could parse and a business model that assumed users would pay a subscription in an era that hadn't learned to. He's the "we told you so" ghost of the franchise: shows up in later Phases as a bitter, brilliant consultant everyone secretly wants to hire and nobody wants to publicly credit. Tragic-comic energy — think the guy who invented the thing everyone else got rich off. His resurfacing arrives in `scripts/THE_ROSTER_3.md` (the Aldrich Killian analog): a verification/authenticity platform he pitched directly to Marc-Anthony in THE ROSTER's earliest days,

turned down in ten minutes and forgotten, resurfaces as THE UNSEEN — synthetic media proving the exact point nobody let him make the first time. Ends the film credited, on the record, rather than merely hired quietly.

THE MENTORS & GATEKEEPERS

The old guard. Not obstacles for their own sake — people with real reasons to be cautious, which makes them harder to write off than a stock "no" character.

EVELYN MARCHETTI-HALE — Legacy media executive, the kind of person who ran a magazine empire in the 90s and now sits on four boards, terrifying in the specific way that competence is terrifying. She's the one who has to decide, repeatedly across Phases, whether to buy in, buy out, or shut down whatever the founders are building — and she's good enough at her job that she's right roughly half the time, which is what makes her a genuine obstacle instead of a punchline. She develops real respect for Esther in particular — two women who've spent their careers being underestimated on sight, recognizing it in each other. Escalates into the franchise's most dangerous villain yet in `scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md` (the Alexander Pierce analog): genuinely convinced that THE VERDICT, a predictive-suppression system running secretly beneath every board she sits on, protects the industry from harms she's spent a decade watching up close. Removed from every board and referred to Senator Ashworth-Okafor's committee once exposed.

REGGIE "COACH" THIBODEAUX — Marc-Anthony's first manager, back from the child-star days — the man who actually taught this whole friend group how the industry works before any of them could drive. Semi-retired by 2004 but never fully gone, the guy who still gets a call whenever anyone in the friend group is about to make a decision they'll regret. Functions as the group's institutional memory and conscience — the person who can say "I watched you at eleven years old, don't lie to me" and actually mean it. Warm, blunt, occasionally the only person who can get through to Marc-Anthony when even Amond can't.

DR. ADAEZE OKONKWO-BRENNAN — Stanford computer science professor turned reluctant industry oracle — the person every founder in the ensemble eventually has to sit across from and explain their idea to, badly, before they're ready. Doesn't found anything herself, doesn't invest, doesn't want the spotlight — she teaches, and half of Silicon Valley owes her their actual technical literacy. Recurring across Phases as the person who asks the one question that reframes everything ("what happens when this works *too well*?"), which becomes a running thematic device rather than a single scene. First activated on-screen in `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`, where she's the only investor-adjacent figure who takes Arianna Cummings's idea seriously before it's polished.

THE PRESS

Because a media empire needs its own press to cover it — the people writing the story of the story.

JULES ABERNATHY-KIM — Tech journalist, the one byline every founder in this universe checks for first and dreads most. Started as a blogger nobody took seriously, ends up the single most powerful voice in how the public understands every platform in TSU — a direct parallel to how the platforms themselves rose. Fiercely fair in a way that reads as ruthless to whoever's currently on the wrong side of a story. Not a villain, not an ally — an actual check on power, which the franchise needs at least one of.

First fully activated in `scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md` (the Sam Wilson position) — already circling THE VERDICT for months without a confirmable source before Arianna and Marc-Anthony's investigation gives her one.

MARISOL VEGA-ODUYA — Entertainment-industry columnist, decades deep, the one who covered the core seven back when they were still child stars. Knows where every body is buried because she was there when most of them were born, industry-speaking. Her columns are the thing that keeps Arianna's "hasn't broken through" storyline publicly visible — a running, low-grade humiliation that Marisol never intends maliciously but can't help noting, item after item, year after year.

THE WILDCARDS

The ones who don't fit a category — which is exactly why they're valuable to a seven-person core cast that risks feeling insular.

BENJI OYELARAN-COX — A hacker-prodigy teenager who shows up in Phase 1 as a nobody and by Phase 3 is quietly indispensable to half the platforms in the universe. Non-binary, uses they/them, the kind of technical talent that makes every founder in the ensemble simultaneously want to hire them and be a little afraid of them. Benji is TSU's "the future is already here, you just haven't met it yet" character — ages up across the whole timeline in real time, a rare franchise element that can visibly grow instead of staying frozen at their introduction. That indispensability has a cost, revealed in `scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md` (the Bucky Barnes analog): did uncredited early engineering work on THE FRAME, presumed to have simply moved on when they stopped showing up, and was actually found, isolated, and slowly convinced by Evelyn Marchetti-Hale over three years that maintaining THE VERDICT was protective work rather than a censorship machine with no appeal. Not prosecuted once exposed — publicly credited for coming forward and welcomed back into the ensemble's orbit, the same mercy this franchise extends to every genuinely remorseful person it puts through the wringer.

SISTER ROSALIND OKONJO — A nun — genuinely, actually a nun — who ends up running one of the earliest and most surprisingly effective community-moderation teams for one of the Phase 1 platforms, because her parish's youth group needed somewhere safe to talk and she simply built the rules herself before anyone official did. Completely unexpected, completely delightful, and quietly one of the franchise's sharpest satirical devices — she out-moderates entire trust-and-safety departments for a decade using instincts she developed running a church basement. Recurring comic-but-sincere presence; never played as a joke about religion, always played as a joke about corporate incompetence next to someone who simply has good judgment.

KWAME "K-DOT" ASHFORD-PETROV — Half-Russian, half-Ghanaian, the group's inevitable wildcard best friend from outside the industry entirely — a day-trader-turned-early-crypto-believer who's either going to be right about the future or lose everything trying. Went to high school with Amond, never left the old neighborhood, the one friend in the ensemble who has zero interest in fame and enormous interest in money — which makes him useful, dangerous, and occasionally the funniest person in any scene he's in. His arc across Phases tracks the actual boom-bust rhythm of internet-era finance, giving the franchise a second economic engine besides "which platform is winning" to dramatize.

FELICITY DRUMMOND-ASANTE — A former child star herself — but from the *other* dynasty, a rival Hollywood family to the Bullocks, which means she's grown up simultaneously adjacent to and in quiet

competition with Marc-Anthony his entire life. Not a villain, not a love interest — something rarer and more interesting, an old, complicated, genuinely fond rivalry between two people who've been compared to each other since they were seven years old and have never fully decided if they like it. She becomes the person best positioned to call Marc-Anthony out when his kindness curdles into avoidance, because she's the only one in the ensemble who's never been intimidated by him.

THE LAWYERS & THE LAW

Every platform franchise eventually lives or dies in a deposition. These are the people who make that dramatically legible instead of just procedurally exhausting.

CONSTANCE ABIODUN-MAYHEW — The litigator who represents whichever co-founder just got frozen out — and she takes every single one of those cases personally, because she was a co-founder herself once, at a startup nobody remembers, and she got frozen out too. Immaculately controlled in the courtroom, quietly incapable of letting a betrayal-of-a-friend case go once she's taken it. She's the one who turns THE ROSTER's founder-dispute subplot (per the Continuity Bible) from a plot beat into an actual courtroom set piece — sharp, empathetic to her client, allergic to anyone who tries to charm her, which makes her one of the only characters in the ensemble who is fully immune to Marc-Anthony's magnetism. That immunity is the point: she's a mirror for how the audience should be reading him in his worst moments.

SENATOR GWENDOLYN ASHWORTH-OKAFOR — A first-term senator who makes her name hauling founders in front of committee hearings — not performatively, she genuinely believes someone in government needs to understand this technology before it's too powerful to regulate. Recurring across Phase 2 through 4 as the institutional check the franchise needs (mirrors the real-world Congressional-hearing beat the Continuity Bible already calls for). She's not written as a cartoon politician scoring points — she does her homework, asks the question that actually lands, and every founder in the ensemble privately respects her even while publicly dreading her subpoenas.

MARCUS THIEN NGUYEN-BRANDT — The fixer. Not a lawyer technically, though he trained as one — the person every platform's board quietly calls when a scandal is about to break and they need it contained, settled, or buried within 48 hours. Morally gray in a way none of the other supporting characters are allowed to be: genuinely good at his job, genuinely useful, genuinely a little bit corrosive to be around for too long. He's the ensemble's answer to "what does it actually look like when a company chooses reputation management over doing the right thing" — a recurring temptation more than a recurring villain, offered to different founders at different low points across the Phases. First activated in `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md` (the Loki analog) — genuinely helps Tyrese Avery at real cost to himself, and quietly absorbs a meaningful share of the collapsed Vernon Price/Maxwell Sterling Asante operation into his own hands in the process, unnoticed by anyone he helped. The corrosive side of him was never fully gone; it just waited for a use.

THE FAMILY BUSINESS

Industry parents, industry children — because in this world, "nepo baby" isn't an insult, it's the whole ecosystem, and it deserves more than one family on screen.

VIVIENNE OKONKWO-STRAND — Legendary casting director, the single most powerful gatekeeper in the ensemble's world before any of these platforms existed — the woman who can make or break an audition with one raised eyebrow, and the one who first said no to Arianna, twice, for reasons that had nothing to do with talent. Not a villain — she'll tell you flatly, years later, that she was wrong about Arianna, and mean it. She represents the old-guard gatekeeping system the entire franchise is implicitly arguing against, which makes her eventual, reluctant respect for what the founders built land as real thematic payoff rather than a cheap redemption arc.

AUGUSTINE "GUS" OYELARAN — Benji's father — a former backup dancer turned high school computer science teacher, the person nobody in the tech world has heard of who is quietly responsible for teaching half the ensemble's eventual engineers how to code in a public school computer lab with outdated machines. He never asks for credit and never gets it; his arc across the Phases is a slow-burn "the people who actually built the foundation get erased from the story" throughline, which gives the franchise a working-class corrective to all the founder-mythology glamour elsewhere in the cast.

THE ONES INSIDE THE HOUSE

Internal threats. The most dangerous kind — because you hired them.

THEODORE "TEDDY" ASHCOMBE-VANCE — The first major hire at one of the Phase 1 platforms — brilliant, magnetic in his own right, and slowly, believably revealed across two Phases to have been building his own leverage inside the company the entire time. Not a mustache-twirling mole — the tragedy of Teddy is that he starts out completely loyal and genuinely talented, and the platform's own culture (the ambition, the speed, the money) is what corrodes him — betrayal that grows from inside the walls rather than being planted there. His full reveal, promised since `scripts/THE_ROSTER.md`, lands in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`: two years of quietly feeding Cassius Wren competitive intelligence, exposed live, in front of the same cameras that once broke Amond Baker.

NADIA CHEN-OYELOWO — Head of Trust & Safety at one of the mid-Phase platforms, the person stuck actually enforcing the content-moderation rules everyone else in the C-suite would rather not think about. Overworked, underpaid relative to the engineers, quietly the moral conscience of whichever platform she's attached to — the one person in the room during a crisis who's actually read the policy she's being asked to bend. Built specifically to pair against Sister Rosalind's storyline: two very different women doing the same essential, thankless job at wildly different scales, one running it out of a church basement, one running it for four hundred million users.

CASSIUS'S TABLE

Every rival founder in a real tech story has a team behind them, not just a solo genius — Cassius Wren needed his own core cast, both to make him a credible threat and to give the franchise a rival ensemble that can plausibly mirror, contrast with, and eventually splinter apart from the core seven's own dynamic.

YOLANDA "YO" FERREIRA-ASHE — Cassius's co-founder and technical counterweight — the actual engineer behind half of what he takes credit for in interviews, and the only person on earth who can tell him no and have it stick. Where Cassius is speed-as-ideology, Yolanda is the one quietly checking whether the thing they're shipping actually works. Her arc is the tragedy sitting underneath Cassius's rise: the smartest person in his company, permanently second-billed. She decides, finally, in

scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md — handing Priya Ramasubramanian's team the evidence of THE EVERYTHING's rushed security flaw rather than accept being overruled one more time.

DARIUS "DEZ" OKONKWO-FAIRWEATHER — Cassius's college roommate turned Chief Growth Officer — the one who figured out early that the fastest way to make a platform feel important is to make it feel exclusive, then engineer the leak that makes everyone else desperate to get in. Ethically the most flexible member of any founding team in the ensemble; not evil, just allergic to the idea that there's a difference between marketing and manipulation. He's Cassius's id, the one who actually executes the ruthlessness Cassius merely believes in philosophically.

PENELOPE ASH WREN — Cassius's older sister and, quietly, the money behind his first eighteen months — family capital dressed up in later interviews as a scrappy garage-bootstrap story. She's the keeper of the actual, un-mythologized origin story, which makes her dangerous to Cassius in a way no outside rival ever could be: she's the one person who can correct the record. Whether she ever actually does becomes a slow-burn tension across multiple Phases.

THE FIXERS OF PERCEPTION

Marcus handles scandal containment. These two handle the much longer game — shaping how the public feels about a platform before there's even a crisis to manage.

IMANI OKAFOR-LINDQVIST — Head of Communications for whichever platform is the ensemble's current darling — not related to rival founder Desmond Okafor-Lindqvist, a coincidence of a common surname that she is aggressively, hilariously tired of explaining at every industry mixer. Where Marcus contains disasters after they happen, Imani's entire job is making sure they never look like disasters in the first place — she's the one who decides which founder does the tearful sit-down interview and which apology gets a single tweet. Sharper than almost anyone gives a "comms person" credit for; she reads a room the way Priya reads a term sheet.

BASTIEN OYELARAN-KWEKU — Brand strategist, the person responsible for making a platform's product *feel* like a movement instead of a company — the actual author of half the taglines and manifestos the founders get credited for improvising in the moment. A little bit of a showman, genuinely brilliant at translating an engineer's abstraction into something the public will get emotional about. His storyline is a running question the franchise keeps circling: at what point does "telling the story well" become "telling a story that isn't quite true"?

THE WORLD BEYOND SILICON VALLEY

Once a platform goes global — which every one of them eventually does — the story needs people outside the U.S. entertainment-and-tech bubble the core seven grew up in. Reserved primarily for Phase 3–4 storylines once international user bases start mattering to the plot.

AMARA OYELOWO-DUARTE — Head of the São Paulo office that turns one of the mid-Phase platforms from an American product into a genuinely global one — Brazilian, sharp, and permanently exasperated by American executives who think "international expansion" means translating the app and calling it done. She's the one who has to explain, repeatedly, that a feature built for one culture's social norms can be actively harmful in another's — a recurring, substantive tension rather than a token "the world is big"

gesture.

KENJI ADEYEMI-HARALD — Half-Japanese, half-Nigerian, runs content policy for the Asia-Pacific region out of Singapore — the person who ends up in the middle of TSU's thorniest cross-cultural moderation disasters, because he's the one person in the company who actually understands why a rule that works in California breaks somewhere else entirely. Wry, exhausted, weirdly good in a crisis specifically because he's had so much practice being the only person in the room who saw it coming.

CHIOMA ASANTE-REYES — A London-based EU regulator, the person who makes it clear to every platform in Phase 4 that America's comparatively light-touch approach to tech regulation is not the only approach in the world. Functions as Senator Ashworth-Okafor's international counterpart — where the Senator represents the U.S. government's institutional check, Chioma represents the much sharper teeth of European regulation, and the contrast between the two becomes a genuine plot lever once a platform tries to play one regulatory regime against the other. Named, not yet appeared, in `scripts/THE_FRAME_2.md`'s stinger — Priya circles her on a map of international regulatory filings, years ahead of her locked Phase 4 arrival, the same way this franchise's stingers have always planted names before paying them off.

THE OTHER MONEY

Priya isn't the only investor in this world — she's just the one the founders want in the room. This is who they get when she says no, or when a rival needs their own war chest.

MAXWELL STERLING ASANTE — The investor Cassius's team actually took money from — old-money adjacent, the kind of venture capitalist whose family name opens doors Priya has to earn her way through every time. Where Priya built her fund from nothing after being passed over, Maxwell inherited his seat at the table and has never once had to question whether he belonged there. Not a mustache-twirler — genuinely sharp, genuinely a value-add to the companies he backs — but his money always comes with a quiet expectation of loyalty that Priya's never does, and that difference becomes the actual philosophical argument the franchise is having about what kind of capital builds what kind of company. Backs Eldridge Kane in `scripts/THE_ROSTER_2.md` and, a second time, Vernon Price's THE LULLABY in `scripts/THE_PROJECTOR_2.md` — a man who keeps chasing the next flashy pitch regardless of what the last one cost him.

DELPHINE OKONKWO-ASH — Priya's fiercest rival in the investment world — ran the fund that passed on THE ROSTER in its earliest days and has spent every year since publicly insisting she was right to, even as the numbers say otherwise. Brilliant, proud, incapable of admitting a miss gracefully, which makes her one of the ensemble's most purely entertaining recurring antagonists — not dangerous to any single founder, but dangerous to the historical record, since she's constantly trying to rewrite what actually happened in rooms she was in. First activated on-screen in `scripts/THE_FRAME.md`, backing Celeste Marlowe's rival app — a miss she also, predictably, won't ever admit to.

THE UNION

Every platform in this universe eventually has thousands of invisible people keeping it running — content moderators, gig delivery drivers, warehouse and data-center staff — and by Phase 3–4, some of them start organizing. This is the labor side of the story the founder-mythology genre usually leaves out.

CORDELIA "CORDY" ASHFORD-NNAMDI — A contract content moderator turned accidental labor organizer — spent two years reviewing the worst content on one of the mid-Phase platforms for a fraction of what the engineers down the hall make, and decided somewhere around year three that "we signed an NDA" wasn't the same thing as "we signed away the right to talk to each other." Not a firebrand by nature — she's exhausted, specific, and devastatingly good at explaining exactly what the job actually costs a person, which is what makes her impossible for a platform's PR team (see Imani) to spin around. Her storyline is the franchise's most direct answer to "what does this industry actually run on, underneath the founder mythology."

MARCUS OYELARAN-VANCE — No relation to fixer Marcus Nguyen-Brandt, and pointedly annoyed whenever the coincidence comes up in a scene with him — a former gig-platform driver turned full-time organizer, the person who takes Cordy's content-moderation fight and connects it to a much bigger labor movement spanning multiple platforms at once. Where Cordy's storyline is intimate and specific, his is structural — he's the character who can say out loud, across a Phase-spanning arc, that all of these seemingly separate platforms are running on the same underpaid, undervalued labor pool, just with different names on the door.

THE ELDER

Someone who was actually there at the beginning — before Phase 1, before any of the founding four existed — giving the franchise a living thread back to its own prehistory instead of treating Phase 0 as pure backstory.

AUGUST WEATHERSBY-OKONJO — The last known employee of THE LEDGER, the Phase 0 platform that died in 2001 — now in his late 50s/early 60s, working an unglamorous IT consulting job, and treated by absolutely nobody in the industry as the historically significant figure he actually is. He watched the very first version of this entire war happen and lost, quietly, decades before any of the core seven were old enough to understand what a platform even was. He resurfaces across multiple Phases — sometimes as expert testimony in one of Senator Ashworth-Okafor's hearings, sometimes as an unlikely consultant a younger founder tracks down out of curiosity — always carrying the same weary, hard-won thesis: he's watched this exact story happen before, and nobody who's currently living it believes him yet. Someone who has seen the whole cycle complete once already and knows how it ends before anyone else does. First activated on-screen in `scripts/THE_ASSEMBLY.md`'s stinger, watching THE EVERYTHING's collapse with total, quiet recognition.

USAGE NOTES

- **The Rivals** exist to make Phase 1–2 tension external as well as internal — every founder needs someone other than their own friend group to struggle against, or the whole franchise risks feeling like a bottle episode.
- **The Mentors & Gatekeepers** are written to be *right* often enough that saying no to them costs the founders something real — a mentor who's always wrong isn't a mentor, just an obstacle.
- **The Press** characters are built to recur across every Phase without aging out of relevance — journalism as an institution is one of TSU's few characters that can plausibly watch the entire saga from Phase 0 to Phase 4.

- **The Wildcards** are the deliberate answer to the core seven's insularity — Benji, Sister Rosalind, K-Dot, and Felicity each pull the world outward into a different subculture (tech-prodigy, faith community, finance, rival dynasty) the founders wouldn't otherwise touch.
- **The Lawyers & The Law** exist to make the Continuity Bible's "legal/courtroom drama" subgenre (see Format & House Style, §2) a recurring engine with actual characters attached, not just an offscreen plot device — Constance, Senator Ashworth-Okafor, and Marcus each give a different Phase's legal jeopardy a human face.
- **The Family Business** characters exist to widen the franchise's theme of gatekeeping and inheritance beyond just the Bullock dynasty — Vivienne is the old system, Gus is the uncredited foundation underneath the new one.
- **The Ones Inside The House** are reserved specifically for internal-betrayal storylines — per the Continuity Bible's Villains Bench rules (§5), a platform's downfall must always trace to a character decision, and Teddy and Nadia are built to be exactly that kind of decision, made by people the audience has already grown to trust.
- **Cassius's Table** exists so the franchise's primary rival isn't a lone genius — Yolanda, Dez, and Penelope give his storyline the same ensemble depth the core seven have, and each is built with their own fracture point (credit, ethics, and truth respectively) that can splinter the rival team apart the same way real startup co-founder relationships do.
- **The Fixers of Perception** are a deliberate companion/contrast to Marcus — Imani and Bastien handle the slower, subtler work of narrative-shaping, which lets the franchise dramatize "spin" as an ongoing practice rather than only a crisis-response scramble.
- **The World Beyond Silicon Valley** is reserved primarily for Phase 3–4, once platform user bases genuinely globalize — Amara, Kenji, and Chioma exist specifically to stop TSU's back half from being an all-American story despite its subject matter going worldwide.
- **The Other Money** gives the franchise a genuine investor-side rivalry to run parallel to the founder-side one — Maxwell contrasts with Priya on *how* capital behaves, and Delphine gives the ensemble a recurring, lower-stakes comic antagonist built entirely around rewriting her own history.
- **The Union** exists so the franchise's founder-mythology genre doesn't accidentally erase the labor underneath it — per the franchise's "100% faithful to source material" mandate, the real history of this era includes real organizing fights, and Cordy and Marcus O-V give that its own throughline rather than leaving it as background texture.
- **The Elder** exists to make Phase 0 more than pure backstory — August is the one character who can walk into any Phase and tell the founders, credibly, that he's seen their exact story before it happened to them.
- Per the Continuity Bible's 70/30 rule: Priya, Dr. Okonkwo-Brennan, Jules, Benji, Senator Ashworth-Okafor, Marcus Nguyen-Brandt, Imani, Chioma, Delphine, Marcus Oyelaran-Vance, and August are your strongest candidates for genuine cross-Phase recurrence (the 30% bucket) since their roles don't depend on any single platform's timeline. Cassius, Yolanda, Dez, Penelope, Desmond, Evelyn, Marisol, Sister Rosalind, K-Dot, Felicity, Constance, Vivienne, Gus, Teddy, Nadia, Bastien, Amara, Kenji, Maxwell, and Cordy are more naturally Phase- or platform-specific (the 70% bucket) unless a later pass decides to extend them.

Doc status: Open. Add characters as new Phases, platforms, and storylines demand them.